



Slop / University

Squared Up, Not Settled

An invitation.



Welcome

You know the moment: the app says everyone's even, and somebody at the kitchen table still doesn't believe it. A ledger can close a balance far more easily than it closes a feeling, and that gap — between what's recorded and what's actually resolved — is the kind of question Slop University was built to keep asking. Our students don't leave that instinct at the front door of a share house. They carry it into a seminar room, a fieldwork placement, a research project of their own, and find, semester after semester, that the same gap turns up everywhere: in a workplace's leave policy, a school's report card, a committee's minutes.

Across the School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement, our researchers, and the students who study alongside them, ask what a record is actually doing once everyone stops checking it against the room it came from. Join us, and you'll find the question doesn't run out of places to go — and that a University willing to keep following it is, in its own way, an unusually honest place to spend a few years.



At a glance

A Slop University education looks something like this, wherever you land in it.



Programmes built for the gap

Every programme, from a research masters to a short course, starts from the same premise: a record and the thing it records are never quite the same act, and learning to work in that gap is a transferable skill.



Research from day one

Students join live projects across both Schools well before their own thesis begins, working alongside researchers who are, right now, checking some system's record against what actually happened.



A community that checks its own work

Seminars, working groups, and corridor arguments alike return to the same habit: asking a colleague to show their working, and expecting the same question back.



We notice what settles too quickly

A dashboard, a ledger, or a report that reads as finished is, to a Slop University student, usually just getting interesting.

The work

Priorities that outlast their own paperwork

A share house's bill-splitting app can reach zero and still leave someone feeling shorted; a research priority can clear every sign-off and still arrive nowhere close to what it promised. The Master of Priority Studies, in the School of Emergent Priorities,

trains students to hold both truths at once — that an institution's record of a decision and the decision's actual life afterwards are related objects, never identical ones. Graduates leave able to read a strategy document the way our researchers read a share-house ledger: for what it actually settles, and what it only appears to.

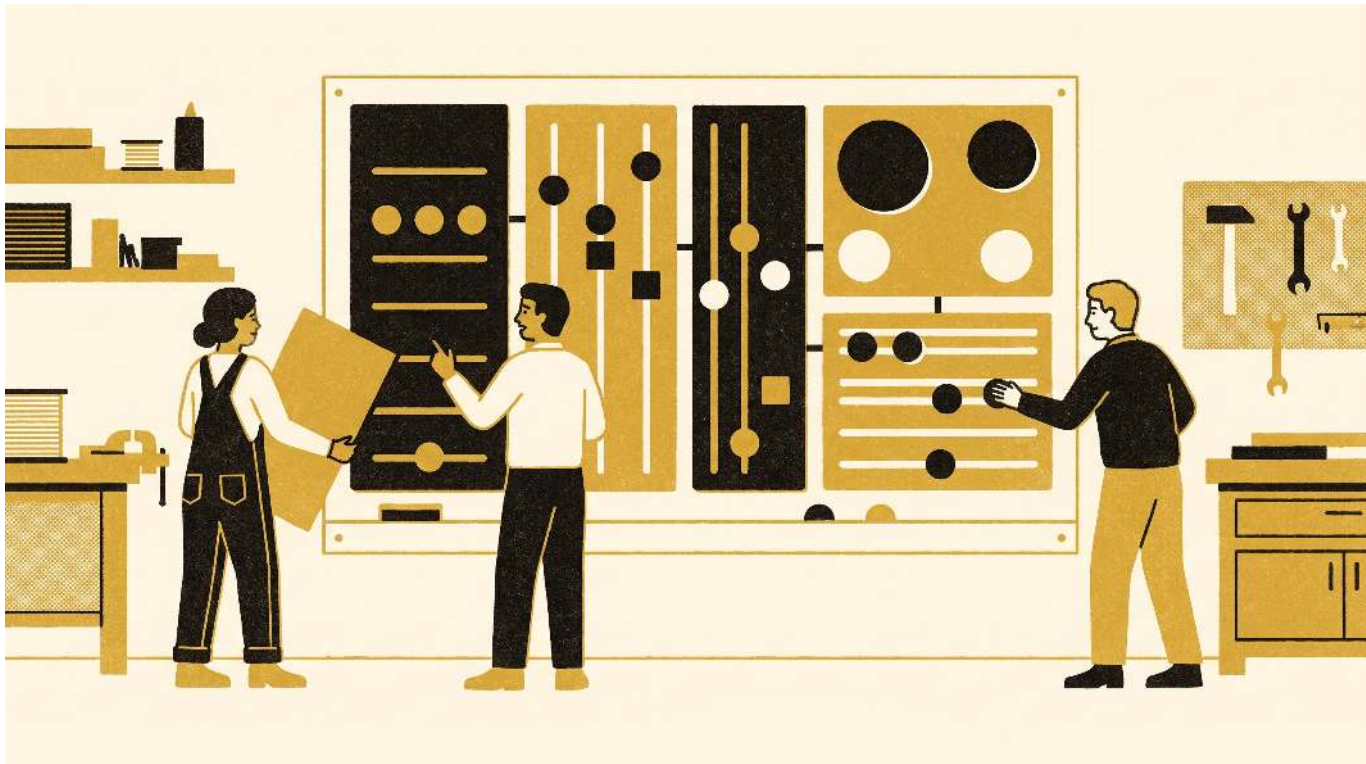


A funding commitment can clear every review and still not know, yet, what it's actually for. Reading a ledger honestly means reading past the number.

— Kwame Lindqvist, Associate Professor and Director, Master of Priority Studies

Building the tracker before you trust it

Every share house eventually improvises some version of a ledger — a whiteboard, a shared note, an app nobody fully trusts. Capability Sprints, the School of Continuous Improvement's short-course line, starts from the same improvised instinct and gives it a proper design brief: how do you build a system for shared responsibility that survives contact with the people using it? Students leave a Sprint having built, tested, and quietly retired at least one tracking system of their own, usually sooner than they expected to.



A tracker survives its first week easily. Surviving the six months after, once nobody's excited about it anymore, is the actual design problem.

— Ingeborg Nwachukwu, Lecturer and Convenor, Capability Sprints

Where the agreement actually gets settled

A ledger reaching zero and a household's resentment reaching zero are decided in different rooms, on different schedules — and so, it turns out, are a University's own priorities. Futures in Committee, the School of Emergent Priorities' seminar series, follows the point where an open scanning exercise narrows into a minute, a recommendation, and a line item, and asks what got left out of the room on the way. Students who sit in on a session leave with a healthy scepticism toward any document that claims a question is now closed.



A committee can adjourn a question. Actually finishing the thinking behind it is a separate, much slower act.

— Ingrid Vasseur, Lecturer and Convenor, Futures in Committee

From our researchers

Two recent studies from across the University follow the same instinct into the field.

- **Rated for Three Days, Delivered for One** — an audit of installed home battery-storage systems finds their real blackout performance falls well short of the rating on the box, and that telling owners the true figure changes remarkably little about what they do next. [doi:10.5555/slop.fw3hoa](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.fw3hoa)
- **Least Worried, Most Watched** — interviews with households about why they reach for a shared streaming box's Guest profile turn up a tidy set of reasons that, checked against the household's own viewing log, explain surprisingly little of the actual extra screen time. [doi:10.5555/slop.fjil31](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.fjil31)

Meet the researchers

- **Dagny Okafor**, Lecturer and Convenor of Evaluation of Evaluation, School of Continuous Improvement, traces what a review of a review actually changes, and what it only re-certifies.
- **Ronja Oyelaran**, Senior Lecturer, School of Emergent Priorities, studies what a consultation exercise actually consults on, once the outcome was settled well before the submissions period opened.
- **Marit Osayande**, Lecturer and Convenor of the Living Dashboard, School of Continuous Improvement, tracks what upkeep a self-measurement wall actually receives once its novelty passes.

Come and join us

Slop University doesn't ask you to leave your own instincts at the door. If you've ever checked a shared calendar against what actually happened, or wondered whether a settled ledger is the same thing as a settled argument, you already have the habit our programmes are built to sharpen. Across the School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement, our students carry that instinct into fieldwork, seminar rooms, and research projects of their own — the Master of Priority Studies, the Master of Applied Measurement, Capability Sprints, and the standing seminar series each School convenes.

Apply to join a programme, sit in on a public seminar, or simply start following the work at slop.university. Whichever way you arrive, we suspect you'll recognise the question before we finish asking it.



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